



RANGSIT UNIVERSITY

RSU/IRS 127: INTERCULTURAL COMMUNICATION

COURSE SYLLABUS

COURSE INFORMATION

NUMBER OF CREDITS	3
ACADEMIC TERM	Term 2, 2026
COURSE MANAGER	Dr. Edward Devere Bacon
ADDITIONAL LECTURERS	Aj. Maksim Aj. Krita
OFFICE LOCATION	RIC Main Office, Building 11, 2 nd floor
OFFICE PHONE NUMBER	02-997-2200 Ext. 4012

COURSE ELIGIBILITY

- All students need a minimum 5.5 IELTS band score (or equivalent) in order to enroll in RSU/IRS 127.

PEDAGOGICAL METHODS

- Student-centered blended learning with a flipped classroom approach
- Group presentations
- Group discussions
- Formative Assessment through Homework Assignments
- Use of AI for development of critical thinking skills

CLASS ASSESSMENT

RSU Global! Passport	5%
Attendance	10%
RSU Global! Participation	15%
10 Writing Homework Assignments	30%
Final Exam	40%
TOTAL	100%

GRADING CRITERIA

90 - 100	=	A
80 - 89	=	B+
70 - 79	=	B
65 - 69	=	C+
60 - 64	=	C
55 - 59	=	D+
50 - 54	=	D
49 or below	=	F

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Intercultural communication; definition of intercultural communication, types of culture, factors of intercultural communication; the culture shock, cultural dimension, nonverbal communication, gestures, eye contact, facial expressions, personal distance, haptics, paralanguage, types of communication, contexts, values, and understanding international languages that reflect the cultural values of each race.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

- Apply intercultural communication theories in real peer-mentoring contexts at RSU Global!
- Demonstrate intercultural competence through guided peer mentoring at RSU Global!
- Critically reflect on intercultural experiences at RAU Global! to enhance personal and professional communication skills

COURSE REQUIREMENTS

- Complete the following on time: English pretest & posttest, 10 writing assignments, and a final presentation
- Participation in RSU Global! Passport (Week 3)
- Participation in the RSU Global! as a peer-mentor for the 10-week PAL program

REFERENCES & RESOURCES

- RSU/IRS 127 Moodle
- Digital chapters from course textbook
- Various digital handouts as assigned by individual teachers

RULES & REGULATIONS

- There are 10 online assignments in this course, which CANNOT be accepted AFTER the due date.
- Make sure to be punctual. Attendance will be taken for each class based on your group presentations (and peer feedback), so if you are late or do not participate, your attendance will NOT be recorded.
- Students are to conduct themselves in a professional manner such as avoid talking in class when others are presenting. Academic dishonesty or cheating is not tolerated and is strictly enforced.

TERM 1, 2025: SCHEDULE

TOPICS / DETAILS

1 JAN. 15	Introduction to Intercultural Communication Course orientation, expectations, and assessments Definition and scope of intercultural communication Importance in globalized education and work Icebreaker with RSU Global! peer mentors
2 JAN. 22	Understanding Culture Types of culture: national, social, organizational, individual Surface vs. deep culture (iceberg model) Cultural universals vs. cultural specifics Activity: "Culture as an Iceberg" Mentor sharing: hidden aspects of their home cultures
3 JAN. 29	Cultural Dimensions I Hofstede's six cultural dimensions Case study: Thailand compared with other countries Activity: "Which dimensions shape your communication style?" Preparation for RSU Global! volunteering (roles, expectations, online reflection journals)
4 FEB. 5	Cultural Dimensions II & Contextual Communication (First RSU Global! volunteering week) Hall's high- vs. low-context communication Trompenaars' cultural dilemmas Role-play: miscommunication scenarios PAL Task: Observe whether your mentee communicates directly or indirectly. ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #1
5 FEB. 12	Culture Shock & Adaptation Stages of culture shock and adaptation strategies Case study: international student adjusting to Thailand PAL Task: Ask your mentor about their own adaptation experience in Thailand ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #2
6 FEB. 19	Nonverbal Communication I Gestures, posture, facial expressions Universal vs. culture-specific nonverbals Video analysis of intercultural gestures PAL Task: Identify a gesture or expression that could be misinterpreted in Thailand ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #3
7 FEB. 26	Nonverbal Communication II Eye contact, proxemics, haptics, paralanguage Cross-cultural role-play on personal space and tone Mentor demonstration: greeting rituals from their countries PAL Task: Observe mentor's use of distance or tone ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #4
8 MAR. 12	Verbal Communication & World Englishes English as a Lingua Franca (ELF) Global Englishes and identity in communication Case analysis: misunderstandings in ELF PAL Task: Record examples of how your mentor's English reflects cultural identity ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #5
9 MAR. 19	Values, Beliefs, and Worldviews Kluckhohn & Strodtbeck's Value Orientations Values shaping communication (time, authority, relationships) Mentor activity: cultural values showcase PAL Task: Compare observed values with Thai values ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #6
10 MAR. 26	Intercultural Barriers and Stereotypes Stereotypes, prejudice, and ethnocentrism Attribution theory and intercultural misinterpretation Media analysis: stereotypes in films/ads PAL Task: Reflect on one stereotype you held that changed through mentoring ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #7
11 APR. 2	Identity and Intercultural Communication Cultural identity, social identity, hybrid identities Identity negotiation theory Identity mapping activity PAL Task: Ask mentors how they balance identity in Thailand ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #8

TERM 1, 2025: SCHEDULE (CONT.)

TOPICS / DETAILS

- 12**
APR. 9 Intercultural Competence Byram's Intercultural Competence Model Deardorff's Process Model Group activity: building an "Intercultural Toolkit" PAL Task: Self-assess: which intercultural skill did I show in mentoring?
- ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #9**
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- 13**
APR. 16 Intercultural Communication in Practice & Internationalization at Home (IaH) Applications of intercultural communication in business, education, and healthcare Introduction to Internationalization at Home (IaH): definition, purpose, strategies RSU Case Study: How RSU Global! embodies IaH Group activity: Map out how RSU Global! provides intercultural learning without studying abroad PAL Task: Interview your mentor/mentee: "How has RSU Global! helped you experience internationalization on campus?" Prep session for final presentations
- ONLINE RSU GLOBAL! REFLECTION HOMEWORK #10**
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- 14**
APR. 23 Final Presentations (Group 1) Student projects: "Best Practices in Intercultural Communication at RSU Global!" Presentations link classroom theory with PAL volunteering experiences Peer feedback and Q&A
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- 15**
APR. 30 Final Presentations (Group 2) & Reflection. Remaining presentations. Closing reflection: "What did I learn about myself as an intercultural communicator?" "How can RSU Global! continue strengthening IaH at Rangsit?"